9.4 External Fixator*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I do not like how my leg looks with the frame." **Objective** • Tibial external fixator • Will not look at the leg	**ACTUAL** Disrupted body image related to the external fixator as evidenced by avoidance of looking at the limb.	• Looks at the leg and joins in pin care.	• Explain why the frame is there and how long it will stay. • Encourage him to share in his care. • Suggest loose clothing to cover the frame.	• Achieved when he takes part in care.
Subjective • "How do I clean the pins at home?" **Objective** • Going home with the frame • Cannot describe pin care	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to pin-site care as evidenced by questioning.	• Demonstrates pin-site cleaning.	• Teach pin-site cleaning per protocol. • Teach the signs of infection. • Warn him never to adjust the clamps.	• Outcome reached when demonstrated correctly.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Several pins • Serous fluid at two sites	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: pins traversing skin and bone.	• Pin sites free of infection.	• Inspect the pins daily. • Carry out pin-site care per protocol. • Follow temperature.	• Considered met if no infection develops.

*References for this care plan: [32], [35], [37]. Full entries are listed in Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.